

Salah Joja

Backend Engineer · Node.js / NestJS / TypeScript · Laravel

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PROFILE

I ship backend APIs that other people can build on. In seven months I took a NestJS platform from an empty repository to 54 REST routes on PostgreSQL and Redis, serving a mobile app and a CMS, with ~204 automated tests behind it. I own the parts that are easy to get subtly wrong — authorization boundaries, transactional writes, cache invalidation, idempotent payments — and I learn fast enough to be useful in week one.

EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer

Feb – Aug 2026 · 7 months

Ghaya Go / Tayf — Education & curriculum platform (ghayaplatform.com)

Pre-launch · private Turborepo monorepo · Stripe test mode · top committer on the API

- Owned the backend of a greenfield product: a NestJS modular monolith exposing 54 REST routes to two clients — an Expo mobile app and a Next.js CMS — documented with OpenAPI/Swagger.
- Designed the curriculum data model (Course → Module → Lesson/Quiz → Task) over 10 versioned SQL migrations in PostgreSQL, with transactional publish and delete so partially-written content can never go live.
- Cut mobile cold-load from ~4–5 API calls to ~2 by aggregating the learner view into one endpoint backed by Redis cache-aside — typed keys, TTLs, prefix invalidation written beside every write path — plus read indexes in migration 009.
- Made subscription billing safe to retry: raw-body Stripe webhook signature verification, an event-ID deduplication table written before processing, and idempotent upserts, after diagnosing a renewal bug caused by one event type being cast as another.
- Enforced two authorization boundaries — Clerk JWT for learners, service key plus signed actor ID for audited CMS writes — and closed a scope-bypass flaw that let any authenticated learner post progress against content outside their enrolment.
- Removed a gamification race condition with transactional writes and a UNIQUE (user_id, task_id) constraint; split a monolithic service into five focused services behind a facade.
- Built the quality pipeline: ~204 unit, integration, and end-to-end tests (Jest + Supertest, ~65% coverage), Zod schemas shared across API, CMS, and mobile, GitHub Actions CI, Docker images to GHCR, and liveness/readiness probes.

PROJECTS

Ribat · Multi-tenant education platform · in progress

Building a multi-tenant, offline-first NestJS + Prisma platform for community schools. Architecture complete — seven decision records, tenant isolation, offline sync, threat model — implementation underway; public repo and deployment next.

T_Project · Laravel REST API · public

Citizen-municipality portal API — token authentication with Sanctum, full CRUD, server-side validation, soft deletes, and [Postman/OpenAPI documentation](#) that the frontend team integrated against. Laravel 11, MySQL.

Voting platform · Laravel

Category-based voting with role-based access control, email verification, schema design, and file upload handling.

SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, PHP, SQL

Backend: Node.js, NestJS, Laravel 11, REST API design, OpenAPI/Swagger, monorepo (Turborepo)

Data: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Sequelize, Prisma, Eloquent, Redis, schema design, SQL migrations, indexing

Correctness: database transactions, idempotency, webhook handling, caching strategy, Zod validation

Auth & security: authentication & authorization, JWT, Sanctum, service-to-service auth, audit logging, Stripe billing

Testing: Jest, Supertest, unit / integration / end-to-end testing

DevOps: Docker, containerization, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, health probes, Git (feature branch → PR)

Languages spoken: English, Arabic

EDUCATION

Damascus University — Faculty of Information Technology Engineering, B.Sc. in Software Engineering · expected 2028